



The Canon cameras captured our bullet-time moment quite well thanks to the Fast Frame Rate mode

If you have more control over your subject's position, you'll wind up with a better effect

click on Import Video from the column on the left. For now, import just the feeds from the cameras for the bullet time effect—we'll deal with introductory/concluding footage later.

Once done with that, click Import Pictures and import the frames you selected.

In the bottom pane, click "Show Timeline" to bring up the movie's timeline. Drag the feed from camera 1 from the Collection on to the timeline. Naturally, you don't need all of it, so navigate through the video using the Play/Pause button to get to the rough vicinity of the frame where you will freeze the video, and use the Next Frame/Previous Frame buttons to get to the exact frame. You don't need any of the video after this frame, so hit [Ctrl] + [L] to split the clip at this point and delete the latter part.

Now drag the selected frame from camera 1 on to the timeline. To herald the beginning of the effect, we displayed the frame for a good while. We've also applied a Sepia Tone effect (right-click on the frame in the timeline > Video Effects > Sepia Tone > Add). This gives us a cool *Max Payne 2*-like effect, but more importantly, it masks the (very visible) colour differences in the frames from each camera. Do the same for the frames from the rest of the cameras (except the last one), but reduce their presence on the time-

line a lot more, so that they are displayed for less time. A good way to judge is play back the video—if it looks like a slideshow, maybe you should display frames for a shorter time. We've stretched the last frame out too, to mark the end of the effect.

After you're done placing frames, drag the feed from the last camera on to the timeline. You don't need any of the video before the frozen frame, so navigate to that frame, hit [Ctrl] + [L] to split the clip, and delete the first part. There... you've done it! Save your project and your video. Be sure to save in the AVI format; VirtualDub doesn't open files in the WMV format.

Post Production

Now, we'll mask the imperfections in the video and also add the remaining footage. Open the video in VirtualDub. Go to Video > Filters and click Add. From the filter list, choose Temporal Smoother. This will add some intermediate frames in the bullet time video to make it look smoother. From Video > Compression choose the DivX encoder and save the video.

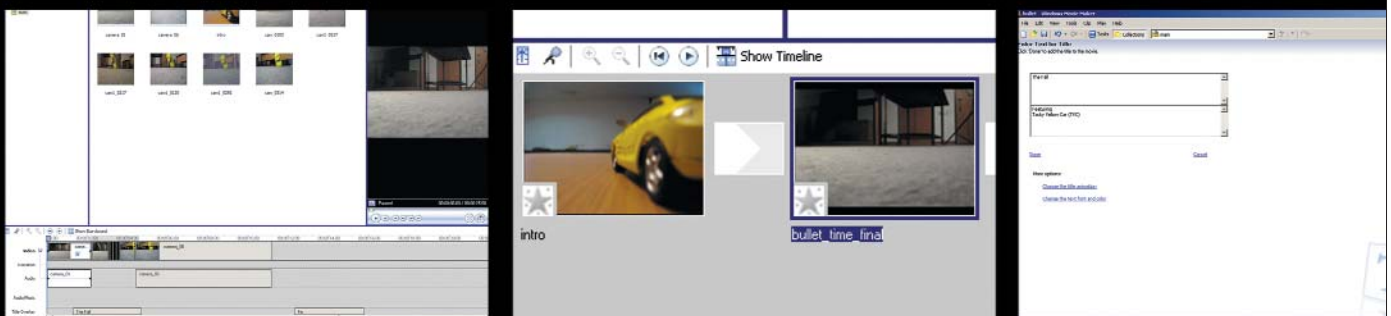
Go back to WMM and import this smoothed clip and the rest of your storyboard-related footage. Unless you need to fine-tune your videos, you can get the job done with the simple Storyboard mode in WMM. Overlay a title, add a soundtrack—anything goes as long as you aren't bored. And you're done!

Pack Up

You can find the result of our endeavours on this month's DVD. It won't win any amateur video awards, and here's the biggest reason why: falling cars are unpredictable—as you can see, our car didn't fall where we wanted it to, resulting in a jittered effect rather than a smooth pan-around. If you have more control over your subject's position, you'll wind up with a better effect.

So the next time you're at home in the rain, don't waste your time on the idiot box—make a few calls and start your own directorial venture! And if you send it to us, we'll even feature it on the CD/DVD for all to see!

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Add all the videos and frames, and tweak timelines

Add your intros and other footage in Storyboard

Throw in some titles and you're done!